

Costco Search Experience Audit

Status: Critical Recommendation Vacuum Detected

100.9M Monthly Visits

\$19.6B Digital Revenue

The Bottom Line



4.4/10

Search Score

Costco serves 100M+ visitors but suffers from critical intelligence gaps.



Removed

Engine Removed

RichRelevance removed.
Zero product recommendations on any page.



\$148M

Revenue Risk

Annual revenue left on the table due to discovery failures.



30-Day

The Ask

Pilot (<\$100K) to prove value on top 100 PDPs.

The Opportunity: \$148M in addressable revenue.



5% Conservative Lift = \$148M/Year

Benchmarks from Lacoste (+37%) and Decathlon (+50%) suggest this is conservative.

A tale of two engines: Strong foundation, missing intelligence.

The Foundation

- ✓ **Latency:** 8/10 (Fast)
- ✓ **Typo Tolerance:** 6/10 (Functional)
- ✓ **Synonyms:** 9/10 (Excellent)

The Intelligence

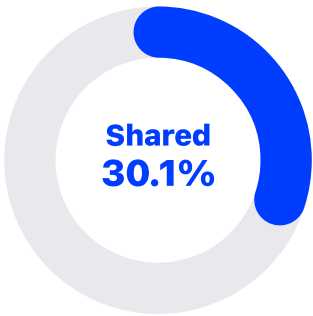
- ✗ **NLP/Semantics:** 2/10 (Fails complex queries)
- ✗ **Recommendations:** 1/10 (CRITICAL VACUUM)
- ✗ **Empty State:** 2/10 (Blank screen)

We don't need to rebuild the basics. We need to inject the missing intelligence layer.

The warehouse sector has a recommendation vacuum. First mover wins.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE: RECOMMENDATION ENGINES

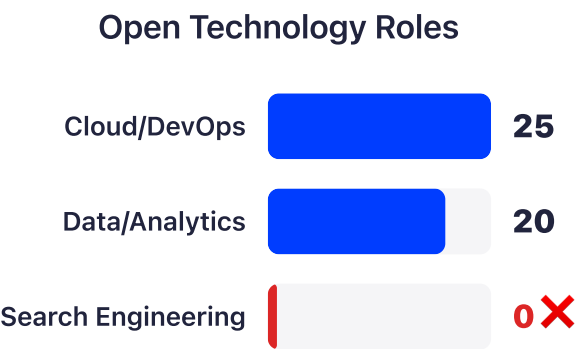
COMPETITOR	REC ENGINE	STATUS
Costco	✗ REMOVED (RichRelevance)	VACUUM
Sam's Club	✗ 5 Engines Removed	REBUILDING
BJ's	— Basic	LEGACY
Walmart	✓ Custom AI	LEADER



Sam's Club shares 30.1% of Costco's organic keywords. [\[4\]](#)

Sam's Club is actively deploying AI. Costco has retreated.

Hiring signals confirm a 'Buy' posture.



BI ENGINEER ROLE

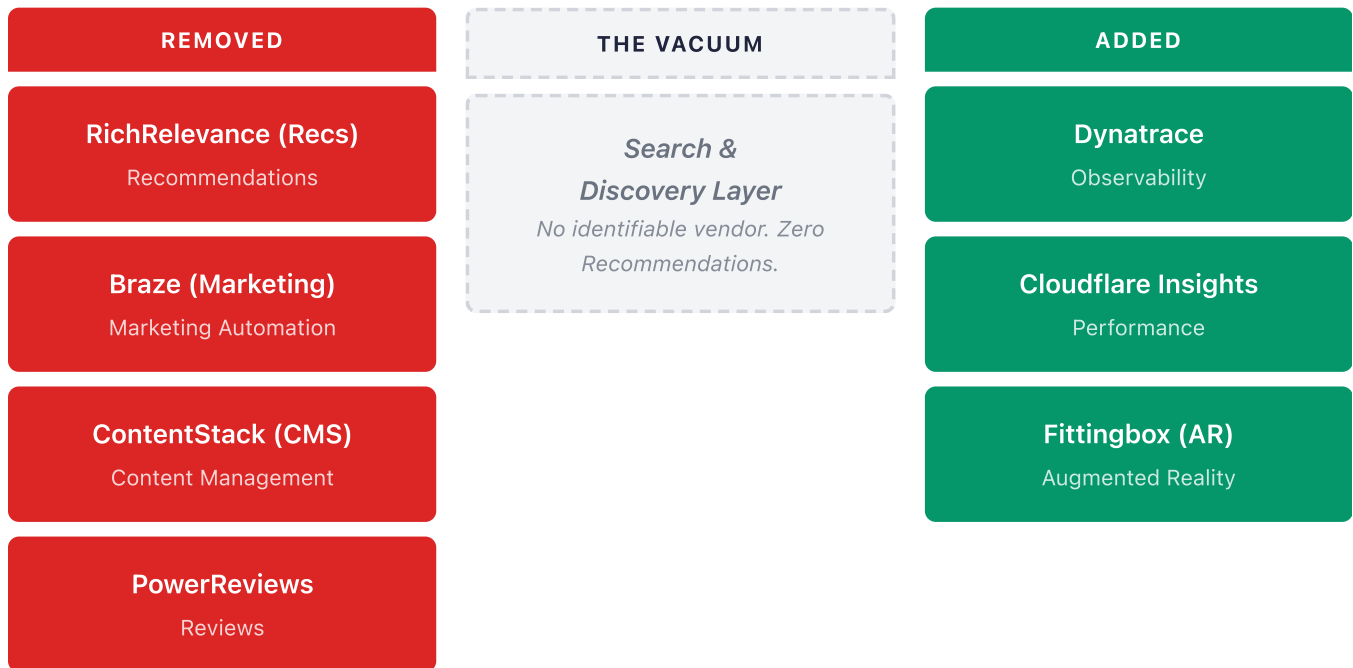
Responsible for measuring search performance...

Responsible for measuring search performance, sitewide analytics, product discovery, and search analytics...

↳ **They measure search. They do not build it.**

You are not building a search engine. **You need a vendor.**

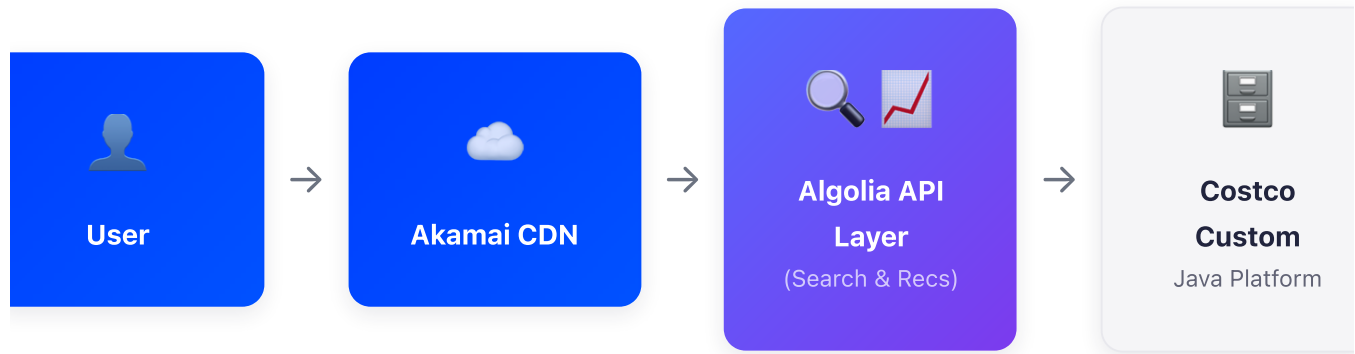
The tech stack is in upheaval — and the search layer is exposed.



The stack is modernizing, but discovery has been stripped bare.

HIGH-END STRATEGIC DIAGNOSTIC

Seamless fit into the Custom Java + Akamai stack.



► **API-First**

No replatforming required.

► **Latency**

Sub-30ms results.

► **Security**

SOC 2 Type II compliant.